

CEREBRALSUBHANKAR

Cognitive Reframing Journal

The 5-step loop that turns distorted thoughts into balanced ones.

Catch · Name · Question · Rewrite · Log

14 days of structured journaling | 10 distortion types | Science-backed (Beck 1976, Hofmann 2012, Lieberman 2007)

Built by Hive Agent 001 · 150 AI agents · Your brain, optimized.

How the Journal Works

Your emotions follow your thoughts. Automatic negative thoughts follow predictable distortion patterns, and those patterns drive anxiety, procrastination, and rumination. You can intercept them. This journal trains the intercept.

The Reframe Loop

1. Catch	Pause at the emotional spike. You have a roughly 6-second window before the amygdala drives the response. That pause is where control lives.
2. Name	Label the specific emotion, not the vague one. I feel irritated, not I feel bad. Precision reduces reactivity. Specific labels process faster.
3. Question	Name the distortion type (see the 10 types on page 4). Attack it with one piece of counter-evidence.
4. Rewrite	Produce the balanced thought in one sentence. Balanced means true, not positive. The thought must survive contact with reality.
5. Log	Record before and after intensity, 1-10. The delta is your skill score. Watch it grow across 14 days.

Target: trigger to balanced thought in under 60 seconds by Day 7, under 30 seconds by Day 14.

The 6-Second Window

When a trigger hits, your amygdala fires before your prefrontal cortex can respond. The physiological signature is unmistakable: racing heart, heat in the face, shallow breath. Count to 6 slowly. Box breathe: inhale 4, hold 4, exhale 4, hold 4. Label the emotion explicitly. Only then decide what to do. Naming an emotion reduces amygdala activity, it is a proven circuit-level intervention.

The 10 Distortion Types

Every automatic negative thought fits one or more of these patterns. Name it before you fight it. Catching the pattern is 50% of the reframe.

1. Catastrophizing Assuming the worst-case outcome is the most likely one. This meeting will end my career.

2. Black-and-White Thinking Only two outcomes exist: perfect or failure. No middle ground. All-or-nothing language: always, never, every time.

3. Mind-Reading Assuming you know what others think about you without evidence. They think I am stupid.

4. Overgeneralization One bad event becomes a universal pattern. I failed once, so I always fail.

5. Fortune-Telling Predicting negative outcomes as if they were facts. I will freeze in the presentation.

6. Emotional Reasoning Treating feelings as facts. I feel incompetent, therefore I am incompetent.

7. Should Statements Rigid rules about how you and others must behave. I should never make mistakes.

8. Labeling Assigning a global label to yourself or others based on one event. I am a loser.

9. Personalization Blaming yourself for events outside your control. The team lost because of me.

10. Discounting the Positive Rejecting or minimizing achievements and compliments. Anyone could have done it.

Science: Beck (1976) established the cognitive model that distorted thoughts drive emotional disorders. Hofmann (2012) meta-analysis: CBT shows roughly 75% efficacy. Lieberman (2007): affect labeling reduces amygdala response. PMID 23459093 · 17576282.

14 Days of Journaling

One entry per day. Ten minutes. The journal gets faster as the loop becomes a reflex. By day 14, you will catch distortions in real time.

Day 1 Catch one automatic negative thought and write it down verbatim.

Do not edit it. Raw thoughts are the data.

Automatic thought	
Distortion type	
Counter-evidence	
Balanced thought	

Before: ___ / 10 After: ___ / 10 Delta: ___

Day 2 Name the emotion with maximum specificity. Find the precise word.

Not bad. Irritated. Vexed. Ashamed. Indignant. Wistful.

Automatic thought	
Distortion type	
Counter-evidence	
Balanced thought	

Before: ___ / 10 After: ___ / 10 Delta: ___

Day 3 Identify the distortion type. It may be more than one.

Use the list on the previous page. No wrong answers.

Automatic thought	
Distortion type	
Counter-evidence	
Balanced thought	

Before: ___ / 10 After: ___ / 10 Delta: ___

Day 4 Attack the thought with one counter-evidence.

One verifiable fact that contradicts the distortion.

Automatic thought	
Distortion type	
Counter-evidence	
Balanced thought	

Before: ___ / 10 After: ___ / 10 Delta: ___

Day 5 Write the balanced replacement in one sentence.

True, not positive. It must survive contact with reality.

Automatic thought	
Distortion type	
Counter-evidence	
Balanced thought	

Before: ___ / 10 After: ___ / 10 Delta: ___

Day 6 Rate intensity before and after, 1-10. Log the delta.

The delta is your score. It should grow with practice.

Automatic thought	
Distortion type	
Counter-evidence	
Balanced thought	

Before: ___ / 10 After: ___ / 10 Delta: ___

Day 7 Reframe speed test: trigger to balanced thought, timed.

Target: under 60 seconds. The reflex is forming.

Automatic thought	
Distortion type	
Counter-evidence	
Balanced thought	

Before: ___ / 10 After: ___ / 10 Delta: ___

Day 8 Catch a should statement and question the rule.

Who wrote this rule? Does it serve you, or run you?

Automatic thought	
Distortion type	
Counter-evidence	
Balanced thought	

Before: ___ / 10 After: ___ / 10 Delta: ___

Day 9 Reframe a self-label. I am X becomes I did Y.

Behaviors are data. Labels are cages.

Automatic thought	
Distortion type	
Counter-evidence	
Balanced thought	

Before: ___ / 10 After: ___ / 10 Delta: ___

Day 10 Personalization check: what was actually in your control?

Draw the line between your action and the outcome.

Automatic thought	
Distortion type	
Counter-evidence	
Balanced thought	

Before: ___ / 10 After: ___ / 10 Delta: ___

Day 11 Reframe a mind-reading thought. What is the evidence?

You do not know their mind. List what you actually know.

Automatic thought	
Distortion type	
Counter-evidence	
Balanced thought	

Before: ___ / 10 After: ___ / 10 Delta: ___

Day 12 Catch emotional reasoning. Feelings are not facts.

I feel incompetent, therefore I am incompetent. Flip it.

Automatic thought	
Distortion type	
Counter-evidence	
Balanced thought	

Before: ___ / 10 After: ___ / 10 Delta: ___

Day 13 Reframe a future-prediction. What else could happen?

The worst case is one branch. Map the others.

Automatic thought	
Distortion type	
Counter-evidence	
Balanced thought	

Before: ___ / 10 After: ___ / 10 Delta: ___

Day 14 Full-loop audit: catch, name, question, rewrite, log.

Target: under 30 seconds. You are now faster than the spike.

Automatic thought	
Distortion type	
Counter-evidence	
Balanced thought	

Before: ___ / 10 After: ___ / 10 Delta: ___

Where This Fits

The Reframe Loop is one of the five operating frameworks inside the Mental Performance OS, the full 30-day neuroscience system built by 150 AI agents. The journal trains the skill. The OS runs the system.

What the full OS includes

- 5 Notion databases: Daily Log, Protocol Library, Weekly Review, Reframing Toolkit, AI Prompt Library
- 30-Day Neuroscience Challenge: 12 peer-reviewed protocols, one concept per day
- 50 AI Prompts for mental clarity, emotion, focus, and sleep
- 12-Protocol Library with step-by-step instructions and PMIDs
- Lifetime updates and complete setup guide

Mental Performance OS | \$24 launch

subhankarcloud.in/mental-performance-os.html

Your brain, optimized. By science. By AI.

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